Lesson 5.1: Deliverability: SPF, DKIM and DMARC

What you learn

- **SPF.** A DNS record that lists the servers allowed to send for your domain.
- **DKIM.** A signature added to each email, checked against a public key in DNS.
- **DMARC.** A policy that says what to do when SPF or DKIM fails and where to send reports. Start with p=none to monitor, then move to quarantine or reject.
- **Honest sending.** These records prove who you are; they do not make unwanted email acceptable. Mail people who asked for it and include a working unsubscribe.

Tools and resources (official sites, not checked live)

- Google sender guidelines
- DMARC overview

ASSIGNMENT

Practice for lesson 5.1

Business problem: Check a DMARC record.

Steps

1. Run the tested parser.
2. Try a record with a bad policy.
3. Write the correct record for your domain.

Expected output: A valid DMARC record with a report address.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

PYTHON

```
def parse_dmarc(txt):
    parts = [p.strip() for p in txt.split(";") if p.strip()]
    tags = dict(p.split("=", 1) for p in parts if "=" in p)
    issues = []
    if tags.get("v") != "DMARC1": issues.append("must start with v=DMARC1")
    if tags.get("p") not in ("none", "quarantine", "reject"): issues.append("p= must be none,
quarantine or reject")
    if "rua" not in tags: issues.append("add rua= to receive reports")
    return tags, issues
```

Example record (use your own domain): `v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:dmarc@example.com`.

Check yourself

1. What does DMARC p=none do?
   Answer: Monitors without blocking.
2. What does DKIM add?
   Answer: A verifiable signature.

Lesson 5.1 of the **Marketing** lessons. See this lesson and its official links on skillnavora.in · All chapters and lessons · Open the full lesson guide. Tools, prices and plans change; confirm on each official site.